

Midnight

T.S

It was dark at the lake, the midnight moon shining as the four boys shivered on the wooden pier.

Brian's teeth chattered.

"Why did you want us out here again Liam?"

Liam bowed his head.

"I didn't want to. It did."

Moonlight flashed, and Graham recoiled as brown fur erupted out of Liam's flesh.

Skin, blood and sinew sprayed onto the pier, buckets of it splashing into the black water.

An empty mask of flesh that once was Liam's face was strewn on top of a snout, a wet black nose protruding out of Liam's dead blue lips.

One clawed paw peeled the face off.

The furry beast smiled pointed teeth, its bright yellow eyes staring at the remaining three boys.

The thing howled up at the sky. The sound was deafening, it felt like it could have pushed Stewart to the ground.

Or maybe it was the fear, the terror, deep in his belly, that made his knees wobble.

Brian, the bravest, took a step forward.

"Liam, are you ..."

The monster pounced, head butting Brian, making him fly backwards with force.

It bounded on its four legs to follow, jumping on top as he landed.

Claws slashed back and forth, eviscerating his stomach.

Brian screamed as crimson soaked into the wood.

Stewart blinked rapidly, he couldn't move, he was rooted to the ground, hot warmth beginning to stream down one leg.

He barely even registered the splash of Graham's dive and swim strokes.

He just watched the flurry of blood and innards that had used to be his friend spray around the pier.

The screams had long since stopped.

The beast withdrew its snout from Brian's flesh to turn and look at Stewart.

Its nose was visibly specked with blood in the moonlight, and it dropped to all fours, prowling forward.

Stewart's legs finally gave, he dropped to the ground and tried to crawl away, wooden splinters piercing his hands as he scraped them on the jetty.

The monster's tongue lolled out. It drew its face next to Stewart's.

One huge golden eye was level with his own.

Stewart could see his crying reflection, and he began screaming, until it was cut off by a sharp, wet crunch.